
TITLE: "SEA MONSTER - SCENES 25 - 30" AUTHOR: ALEX GONZALEZ DATE: 2024-12-01 UPDATED: 2024-12-01 LAST-UPDATED: 2024-12-02

WEDNESDAY

SCENE 25A EXT. OUTSIDE MORNING

Dallas and Mac walk the neighbor's dog but it isn't going well. They walk it by a patch of grass - tall grass - and Dallas looks off into the distance - Mac watches his gaze - and soon does the Dog - the latter too now staring at the great nothingness among the tall grass.

SCENE 25: EXT. DRIVEWAY - EVENING

DALLAS and *MAC* drive to a neighbor's house for dinner. The radio plays in the background.

RADIO ANNOUNCER (V.O.)

And now for your evening weather forecast. Expect clear skies tonight with a slight breeze off the bay side. Perfect weather for the upcoming that Branford Sea Harvest Festival next week. Oh yeah - it should be good this year - get the kids - the get family - the whole family! Though right now the storm seems to be coming in - so you might want to stay indoors - but not too long - because the storm will pass and we should be good for the festival.

SCENE 26: INT. DOMINIC'S SCREENED BACKYARD DECK PARTY - EVENING

The setting sun bathes the backyard in a golden glow of fury. Laughter and sizzling sounds engulf the air as the neighbors mingle upon the backyard screened deck. *DALLAS* stands with *DOMINIC*, who's talking enthusiastically.

DOMINIC

(gesturing with a fork full of ziti)

Yeah, yeah, Hugo--my cousin--throws a big party every summer. You'd really like him-- he used to own a cosignment store out in branford but now he throws these parties - for charity you kno - . You and your boy - what's his name?

Cut To : Kids table:

MAC

Mac

JOCYLEN

Jocylen (beat) nice to meet you - my mom said you and your dad are from minnesota?

MAC

No - we were from Michigian - but we moved around.

JOCYLEN

My mom said that your Dad and my dad work together

MAC

Whose your dad?

JOCYLEN

Rodney Roberts

MAC

What does he do?

JOCYLEN

He makes tools and stuff for the weather.

MAKAYLA

Your dad is absolute Legend - watch your mouth
Jocylen

MAC

Really?

ASHER

I like him

MAKAYLA

He invented the kaledoscope ****

MAC

Where is he?

JOCYLEN

He moved to Florida - i'm here now with my mom and grandma.

MAC

How does my dad know him?

JOCYLEN

My dad says everyone should know your dad.

MAKAYLA

My grandfather was like that

Cut to: Adults Table

(Dominic takes a bite of ziti, then continues)

DOMINIC

My old man - God rest his soul - used to tell me -
Dominic - baby - get with the times - but he wasn't
around much - and I worked the bars - I always
respected what he did though - that with the weather
- I mean, who knows when the next storm might hit

_Dallas nods politely, but seems a bit overwhelmed by Dominic's energy. Mac stands nearby, quietly listening but not engaging, his eyes occasionally drifting to the edge of the backyard. In the far distance there appears to be an object

_MAKAYLA (12) approaches Dominic, hugging him quickly. She then steps back, looking over at Mac as she adjusts her backpack straps.

MAKAYLA

Dad, I'm heading to the back with the others. We'll be back in 20 minutes.

DOMINIC

20 minutes? What do you got to for 20 minutes?

MAKAYLA

I want to show them the fort

DOMINIC

Ooo the secret fort - - Makayla - when you going to show us the secret fort?

MAKAYLA

Yes, Dad.

_Makayla and the crew at the kids table - head toward the far end of the backyard. She disappears into the twilight, silhouetted against the setting sun.

_Dallas watches them leave, as if sensing something in the air, but doesn't say anything. Dominic resumes the animated conversation.

SCENE 27: EXT. MAKAYLA'S SECRET LAIR - LATE AFTERNOON

The deck party continues in the distance. Mac wanders alone near the far end of Makayla's backyard, which stretches to the edge of the coast.

Mac stands still, staring at the water. Waves crash against the rocks. He scans the grass, looking for mysterious eyes, then back to Makayla.

Suddenly, a faint whimper--like an animal in pain--echoes from the wilderness. Nautical sounds engulf him, heightening his fear. The grass rustles, but it's unclear if it's wind or something else.

Frightened, Mac steps back, ready to return to the party. But before he can leave, the kids table emerges from the fog--Makayla, Asher, and Jocylen. They move purposefully, faces serious.

_Makayla steps forward, focusing on Mac.

MAKAYLA

(firm, yet urgent)

Mac, give me that shovel.

Mac hesitates, then nods and grabs a nearby shovel. As he hands it over, Makayla turns to the group, her expression shifting to leadership.

MAKAYLA

You there Mac, Mac?

_Mac takes a short breath and grasps his shovel. He begins to dig and dig and dig - almost in anger - almost too fast.

MAKAYLA

Alright.

_The kids, led by Makayla, move deeper into the tall grass, toward the tallest grass where the coast drops off into the sea. The fog thickens, and the air grows colder.

SCENE 28: EXT. THE EDGE OF THE TALL GRASS THICKET

The crew hang around the tall grass as time moves slowly agaisnt the wind - agaisnt the branches of the tall grass.

_Makayla takes out a pack of hotdogs from Asher's backpack cooler and cleans it on a flat rock - Mac grabs the the shovel leaning agaisnt the outer wall of the wigwam - and Asher slowly brings the baitfish over and puts it in the bucket.

JOCYLEN

Makayla this is crazy

MAKAYLA

Yeah - you think?

JOCYLEN

Makayla

MAKAYLA

What's crazy about it?

JOCYLEN

Huh?

MAKAYLA

You said this was crazy - what's crazy about it - Mac get the shovel and dig a hole by the edge of the lawn - we call that the outpost - we're going to plant another camera - Asher - get the rope swing pulley and string the bags of bait. - - See what we do is tie these bad boys to that tree there - and let them swing -

JOCYLCEN

How do we know this isn't just some racoon getting its kicks oabout it?

_Mac and _Asher diligently set up cameras on the surrounding trees - they hook cables up to a battery pack taped onto a wooden panel.

SCENE 29: EXT. MAKAYLA'S HIDEAWAY - LATE AFTERNOON

_The kids gather at their hideaway--a makeshift wigwam - fort hidden deep in Makayla's backyard old playground set - grass. Inside, houses a rudimentary surveillance system: several portable HDMI Monitors - run by a batterypank tied to a solar panel. Shovels and buckets and poles are propped up against rocks and driftwood, their screens glowing in the dim light. Cables stretch out towards to a jury-rigged power supply--a large battery bank cobbled together from old car batteries and solar chargers.

_ASHER fiddles with the wiring as he ensures each screen is properly connected. Makayla walks over and sits down in front of the monitors. Asher, Mac, and Jocylen behind her.

MAKAYLA

The creatures are likely to come out tonight - the tide.

_Mac looks out the cracks of the makeshift wigwam - through it he watches the tallgrass swaying in the wind.

JOCYLEN

How do you know that?

_They exchange glances.

MAC

What creatures?

ASHER

(setting up a camera)

The wind will pick up and push the smell out -

JOCYLEN

Out where?

ASHER

Out there.

Asher tests the camera pan into the Tall Grass

_Makayla watches Asher set up the final camera.

SCENE 30 - BACK AT THE WIGWAM HQ

MAKAYLA

Asher, the feed isn't working.

_Asher leans over, squinting at the screen.

_He scrolls through the tiny menu of the cheap digital camera, but the screen remains locked in the wrong shutter speed.

MAKAYLA

Just turn the night vision on - we can fix it on
computer

_Mac watches Makayla - and off in the distance - he hears a little noise -
that it seems like only he could hear - he looks out the at the darkening sky,
a hint of worry in his voice.

MAKAYLA

Mac what is it?

_Makayla looks torn, glancing between the malfunctioning equipment and her
friends.

MAKAYLA

But we haven't got the camera working yet. Haaaaaa -
okay - I guess we have enough cameras - Asher go and
record - make sure you are saving it as an mp4.

JOCYLEN

(standing up)

Makayla we ought to go back - its been more than 20
min

MAKAYLA

Go then Jocylen - we are right in the backyard -
tell them we're fine - but go if you need to - go go
go go go.

_Jocylen leaves the wigwam...

CUT TO: EXT. DOMINICS'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

_Reluctantly, they begin to gather their things. Makayla lingers, staring out
at the tall grass with a mix of disappointment and determination.

_As they pack up their makeshift surveillance system, the wind picks up,
rustling through the grass. For a moment, it almost sounds like whispers
carried on the breeze.

